

base station, allowing you to set up a home Wi-Fi network. In the choose back up location menu, if you choose to set up a Time Capsule, the computer searches for a wireless Time Capsule within range, connects to it, and asks you to set it up. You will be asked to enter a username and password for your backup, as the Time Capsule being a network device is expected to serve as a backup location to multiple computers.

Once you have set up your backup location, (a local drive, an external drive or a Time Capsule), you have to click the options button in order to set up its specifics. Here you may choose which parts of your system you do not want to back up (by default, all except your backup drive is backed up). Once you click on the + button, you may browse for a folder, select it and click exclude.

Time Machine by default maintains hourly backups of all your selected (not excluded) folders for the last 24 hours, daily backups for the last week, and weekly backups till your backup drive / Time Capsule is full. You also get to choose in the options menu whether Time Machine should alert you when deleting an old backup due to lack of disk space.

Now on the default Time Machine Menu, you should be able to see current back up drive, the free space available on this drive, the date and time of the newest and oldest backups and the time left till next backup. When this countdown reaches zero, it will take one or two minutes preparing your backup, and a long time (up to a few hours, depending upon the amount of data) backing up your data. However, this happens only with the first backup and subsequent backups are much faster.

To restore data, click on the Time Machine icon from the dock again. This time, you will directly gain access to the time machine interface. Marvel at the beauty of it. The long time tunnel like appearance arranges snapshot views of each of your backups in chronological order, with the newest in the front.

For restoring simple files such as your documents and images, you may use this menu itself. Click on the snapshot that has all the files you need in it, choose restore and in the subsequent menu select what portions of that backup (folders, documents etc) you need to back up.

However, a Time Machine Backup can also be used to restore your computer from scratch, if your operating system files have been corrupted and your computer rendered unusable. To do so:

1. Insert your Mac OS X install disk that came with your computer into your DVD drive and start your computer. If your back up is on an external hard disk, connect it to the computer and turn it on.